The Moon · Word Page

Learning goal: I can explain how the Moon orbits the Earth and why we see different Moon phases.

Words for This Lesson

natural satellite: a body in space, like the Moon, that orbits a planet

reflect: when light from the Sun bounces off the surface of the Moon

phases of the Moon: the changing shapes of the sunlit part of the Moon as seen from Earth

waxing and waning: waxing means the lit part we see is growing; waning means it is shrinking

How to Use These Words

Point to a word when you explain your idea.

Help: The Sun always lights __ of the Moon. As the Moon orbits Earth in __ days, we see different amounts of the __ half.